

SHOWCASE

Embark Dog DNA Test Kit

While human DNA analysis kits have been around for a while now, similar kits for your pets are a more recent phenomenon. Over the years humans have intermingled and so has their DNA, and the same has happened for the fauna on this planet too.

So, it is absolutely reasonable to wonder about the ancestral composition of your pet dog and the Embark DNA kit is a great way to do that. Priced at \$189, the kit does come at a premium over other similar kits, but it also makes up for that with a boatload of features. A simple swab sent to the company gets you information about genetic predispositions through 165 screening tests for things like a risk of developing cataracts at a young age, sensitivity to medications they may need down the road, and the likelihood they'll be affected by a degenerative spinal cord disorder in old age. The general advice is to wait till at least half an hour after the pet has eaten something to take swab. Doing it sooner might throw off the results.

There's an easy-to-use dashboard to navigate this data along with cited research papers for their test methodologies. Things are explained in simple language that tries to not use complicated scientific terminology unless necessary. However, the most interesting part of the results tends to be the ancestral report. It lists down the percentages of the different breeds that constitute the DNA of your pet and also tracks 'maternal haplotypes'. Dogs sharing the



same maternal haplotype are more likely to have common maternal ancestors. The Embark platform also catalogues these results, so you can browse it to see other dogs your furry companion is related to, or maybe even what a 50% French bulldog and 50% Doberman breed looks like. It is quite possible that you might find some connections to some of the famous dogs of the internet today! Sounds like a whole lot of fun.

On the other hand, you can choose to keep the results private and have them at your disposal. In either case, users also have the option to send the results directly to their vets for further analysis, or diagnosis in case of a particular ailment.

Tag Heuer Connected Modular Full Diamond

Whoever is of the opinion that a smartwatch cannot fall into sheer luxury hasn't met the Tag Heuer Connected Modular Full Diamond. It claims to be the most precious connected watch in the world, and with 589 diamonds and a white gold paving, we wouldn't want to disagree. The watch face is enclosed under the scratch-resistant sapphire crystal of 2.5 mm thickness and, in the 45mm configuration, covers a 1.39" AMOLED display that supports multi-finger recognition. The sapphire contributes to giving the face a sheen that only adds to the finesse. At 297ppi, the display steps up to matching the clarity of the diamonds around it. The 41mm configuration not only has a better display, but it also features



double the RAM and storage at 1GB and 8GB respectively. The 410mAh battery is good enough to last you a day with above average usage. It also packages the usual lot of sensors making it a fully functional smartwatch as well, one that is water resistant up to 100ATM. Apart from the diamonds, the configuration of the watch is quite the same as the standard Tag Heuer Connected Modular, except for the \$195,400 additional cost. Even with all of this tech and luxury in it, the Tag Heuer Connected Modular is light and easy on the wrist. Overall, this could very well be the perfect blend of modern technology and classic Swiss watchmaking. Additionally, Tag Heuer is offering the same trade-in program that will let you swap in a mechanical movement for the electronic one once it becomes outdated. This way, you can at least get some mileage out of your near \$200k smartwatch in the long run, right?